

The V70 lacks features when compared to the Sony T68i or the Nokia 6510. You'll find a calendar, a currency converter, a calculator, voice-activated dialling, voice-dialling, 64 ring tones (32 of which are customisable), vibrate mode, two-way SMS, caller ID, conference calling, three games, and wireless Web access. The V70 does not have a calendar option, but has a date book that gives a weekly view of your schedule. This isn't very effective to work with, due to the limited screen size.

The phone supports WAP 1.2.1 and GPRS, and has a Li-Ion power pack, which provides good battery life—a standby time of around three days. The signal reception strength is good and the call quality is acceptable. But when the signal strength does drop, there is appreciable loss in speech.

Overall, it is a very stylish but not a very practical phone. One would expect more features for the hefty price of Rs 16,995. If you want a phone for daily business, which is simple and practical to use, then overlook this phone.

Nokia 3530

Price: Rs 9,099 A-

With the launch of the 3530, Nokia seems to have gauged the market reality well. Thus far, we have seen Nokia overstretching the life of all their models. But with the competition getting hotter, as Sony Ericsson and Motorola are bringing in colour phones to cater to the low-end market, Nokia couldn't afford to be left behind. The 3530 seems to be the perfect answer to counter both, the Sony Ericsson T310, and Motorola's C350.

Nokia shows its traditional strength of bringing in radical design ideas for its cell phones, which makes one sit up and take notice. The 3530 is Nokia's first colour screen model for the masses. It has the typical characteristics of the 3xxx series—a slightly elongated body and weighs around 100 grams. The keypad makes it really stand out from all other Nokia phones, as well as the semi transparent cover, which allows the white backlight through certain parts of the shell.

The 3530 comes with a 4,096-colour display that infuses life into otherwise dull menus and icons on the phone. The colour screen is dimmer, but makes up for it with excellent sharpness. The radically designed keypad is the most responsive keypad on any cell phone that we have come across in this comparison. Although it requires some time to get used to, once done, it is a walk in the park for any SMS junkie.

The menu structure is classic Nokia, with colours added for more fun. The menu is browsed through a four-way keypad. This phone has the fastest processor amongst all the smart phones.

With the Sony Ericsson phones, you have to stare at the hourglass, but the 3530 jumps to the next screen in a flash.

The cell phone comes with all the standard 3 series features, such as SMS Chat, MMS, WAP 1.2.1, calculator, currency

converter, alarm clock etc. Apart from these features, the phone also supports polyphonic ring tones and Java based applications that can be downloaded using high-speed data connections, such as GPRS and HSCSD. Nokia has been considerate enough to provide a 1000 mAH battery for 5 hours talk time and 13 days standby time. The 3530 has excellent signal reception and good voice clarity.

The 3530 makes an excellent package with good features and performance alike. The only drawback is the lack of an IrDA port for communication. It provides you with all you can ask for—the usual Nokia features, a good colour screen and a terrific price of just Rs 9,099.

Nokia 5210

Price: Rs 10,899 B

The 5210 cell phones carry the ruggedness introduced by the 5xxx series of Nokia cell phones to new levels. This is the only phone that has a rubberised protective shell, which to a certain extent, makes the phone water and dust resistant.

The 5210 comes in a burnt orange and pastel blue rubber casing, giving the phone its distinct identity and an aggressive character. The keypad layout is good with ample spaces between keys. The only problem with the keys seems to be the power button, which has to be pressed with all your might. The navigational keys also require additional force. The four-way button navigation buttons make menu browsing simpler.

The menu structure is very simple and effective and browsing through it is a breeze as the shortcuts let one jump directly to the required sub-menu by pressing a combination of keys. It sports a high-resolution LCD display, capable of displaying four lines of text, with a pastel orange backlight.

This phone has been available for over a year now, and the ageing is prominent. The 5210 has a 250 capacity address book, and call registration showing the last 20 dialled, 10 received and 10 missed calls. It has support for long messages and also supports the SMS chat feature. It comes with an in-built PIM functionality, though the calendar view is restricted to only two weeks at a time. This can be frustrating if you use the calendar frequently.

The phone comes bundled with five games, a ring tone composer, stopwatch, count down timer, calculator with currency converter, a thermometer and an inbuilt IrDA port for data transfer. It has a decent standby time of 3 days. As with all Nokia phones, the signal reception is good and voice clarity is excellent.

The only drawbacks are the outdated features and the price. Even after one and half years, the phone still sells at Rs 10,899. This is expensive, when compared to the features that a phone such as the Sony Ericsson T310 offers for a lower price.

